

Team404: Project Proposal – Habit & Budget Tracker

Problem Statement

Most people don't fail at budgeting because they're bad at math — banking apps already show them the numbers. They fail because sticking to a budget takes discipline, day after day, and the app they use to build good habits has nothing to do with the app they use to track their money. Someone might have one app for a workout streak and a totally separate app for bills, and neither one talks to the other. Because of this, a missed bill or a spending problem often isn't noticed until it's already a problem — nothing connects "did I pay my bills" to the same streak-and-reminder system that makes habit apps work in the first place.

Objectives

General Objective: Build a website where users manage their money and their daily to-dos in one place, so paying a bill or saving money feels like keeping a habit going — not just another chore.

Specific Objectives:

- Let users track their money through Accounts (like a bank account or an e-wallet), record Transactions (money coming in or going out), sort transactions into Categories (like Food or Rent), and set one Budget per account.
- Let users organize their to-dos into Projects (like "Bills" or "Personal") and Tasks. Every task has a date, an optional stricter deadline, a priority level, and can be set to repeat (daily, weekly, monthly, etc.).
- Automatically create a task when a user adds a bill (an expense) and marks it "unpaid," so they get a reminder to pay it. If the bill repeats every month, the reminder task repeats too.
- Skip creating a task for repeating income (like a monthly paycheck) — since getting paid doesn't need a "go pay this" reminder.
- Attach exactly one budget to each account, and let the user pick how often it resets: weekly, monthly, every 3 months, twice a year, once a year, or a custom period.
- Show users one combined summary of their spending and their task streaks, instead of two separate, unrelated screens.
- Let two users optionally link their accounts, so a couple or a family can see each other's shared bills and tasks.
- Word recurring bills and savings tasks like a personal promise (e.g., "Pay rent by the 1st, so I stay someone who pays on time"), so it feels like a habit, not just a checkbox.

Proposed Solution

The Habit & Budget Tracker is one website with two connected parts: a **Budget Tracker** and a **Task Tracker**. Instead of building two separate apps, these two parts share the same login and update each other automatically.

Main Features:

1. **Add a bill, get a reminder automatically.** When a user creates an Expense transaction and marks it "Unpaid," the app automatically creates a matching Task to remind them to pay it.
2. **Works for repeating bills too.** If that expense is set to repeat (e.g., rent every month), the task repeats as well. Once the user finishes the task, it comes back on its own for the next due date — no need to recreate it by hand.
3. **Repeating income does not create a task.** If a user sets up repeating income (like a monthly salary), no task is created — there's no need to remind someone to receive money, only to pay bills.
4. **One budget per account.** Each account (a bank account, an e-wallet, etc.) can have exactly one budget attached to it. The user picks how often that budget resets — weekly, monthly, every 3 months, twice a year, once a year, or another custom period.
5. **A bank transfer moves money in two steps, automatically.** When a user picks "Account Transfer" as the transaction type, they choose two accounts: a **source account** (where the money comes from) and a **target account** (where the money goes). The app then does two things at once: it **withdraws** the amount from the source account and **deposits** the same amount into the target account. This keeps both account balances correct without the user having to log two separate transactions by hand.
6. **Finishing a task updates the bill automatically.** Marking the linked task as done also marks that bill as paid, so the user never has to update the budget and the task list separately.
7. **One combined view.** Users see their spending and their task streaks together on one screen, instead of switching between two unrelated apps.

Example: A user adds a monthly "Rent" expense of ₱10,000 and marks it Unpaid. The app creates a "Pay Rent" task under a "Bills" project, due on the 1st of every month. When the user finishes that task, the app marks that month's rent as paid. Next month, the task shows up again on its own — the user never re-types it.

Expected users: anyone who wants to manage both their money and their daily to-dos in one place. The first version supports one account per user, with linked/shared accounts (for couples or families) as an optional add-on later.

References

Todoist (task management — inspiration for the Task module)

- Features overview: <https://www.todoist.com/features>
- Introduction to Projects:
<https://www.todoist.com/help/articles/introduction-to-projects-TLTjNftLM>
- Introduction to Deadlines (Date vs. Deadline distinction):
<https://www.todoist.com/help/articles/introduction-to-deadlines-in-todoist-uMqbSLM6U>
- Introduction to Recurring Dates (Repeat field):
<https://www.todoist.com/help/articles/introduction-to-recurring-dates-YUYVJJAV>

Atomic Habits (book — behavior-change framework)

- Official book page: <https://jamesclear.com/atomic-habits>
- Four Laws of Behavior Change summary: <https://jamesclear.com/atomic-habits-summary>

Atoms (official Atomic Habits app — inspiration for identity-based framing and streaks)

- App site: <https://atoms.jamesclear.com/>

Budgeting app conventions (Accounts, Account Types, Transaction Types)

- YNAB: <https://www.ynab.com/>